

PCI AI Project Controls Leader (PCI PCL-AI)

13 DOMAINS · 61 KNOWLEDGE AREAS · 26 SECTOR CASE STUDIES

A working reference for the professional who owns the cost and schedule truth on a project, written so that every technique arrives with the conditions under which it fails. The AI material is not an appendix. It runs across the delivery lifecycle and ends where every automated output should end: with a named human who verified it.

Part One — Finance, accounting and reporting

Domains 1–4. The financial grammar of project controls. Forty per cent of the Body of Knowledge.

Domain 1 · Foundations of accounting for project controls — 5 knowledge areas

The accounting model · Components of the financial statements · Accrual accounting and the matching concept · Cost provisions and cost accruals · Chart of accounts and cost coding for projects

You do not keep the books. You read them, reconcile against them and report from them every day, and a variance you cannot trace to a ledger entry is an opinion. This domain makes the trace possible.

Domain 2 · Financial reporting and the standards — 5 knowledge areas

The reporting framework · IFRS 15 Revenue from Contracts with Customers · Revenue recognition beyond the basics · Other relevant standards for project controls · Management reporting versus statutory reporting

Domain 1 was the mechanics: how a transaction is recorded. This is the rules deciding which number is recorded and when — and why the figure in the board pack and the figure in the accounts can both be right while disagreeing.

Domain 3 · Budgeting and forecasting — 5 knowledge areas

Budgeting fundamentals · Cost estimation · The time-phased budget, or cost baseline (planned value) · Forecasting · Cash-flow forecasting

A budget is a plan expressed in money. A forecast is reality catching up with it. Estimating, phasing, and knowing when a forecast has stopped being a forecast and become a wish.

Domain 4 · Performance management, variance analysis and management reporting — 4 knowledge areas

Performance management principles · Variance analysis · Management reporting · Data visualisation and storytelling for controls

Measuring correctly is only worth doing if it changes a decision. Turning a variance into a conversation someone acts on, including the part where the chart is honest about what it does not show.

Part Two — Project management

Domains 5–12. The delivery disciplines controls serves. Forty per cent of the Body of Knowledge.

Domain 5 · Cost management and cost control — 4 knowledge areas

The cost management framework · The cost control cycle · Cost breakdown and control accounts · Change control and cost impact

The anatomy of cost on a live project and the loop that stops it drifting: what a control account is for, and why uncontrolled change is the commonest route to an overrun nobody saw coming.

Domain 6 · Earned value management and forecasting — 4 knowledge areas

EVM fundamentals · Variances and performance indices · Forecasting with EVM: the EAC family · Integrating cost and schedule, limitations, earned schedule

The technique that answers the three questions a board actually asks: how much have we done, what did it cost, and what will it cost to finish. Including where EVM misleads, which matters more than where it works.

Domain 7 · Contracts, commercial management, BoQ, invoicing and revenue — 5 knowledge areas

Types of contract · Contract management · Bills of quantities · Invoicing and applications for payment · Revenue recognition in the commercial cycle

The commercial chain from contract form through measurement and payment to the revenue figure — where your numbers meet someone else's entitlement.

Domain 8 · Project management lifecycle — 6 knowledge areas

Initiating · Planning · Executing · Monitoring and controlling · Closing · Development approaches: predictive, iterative, incremental and adaptive

The full lifecycle from the controls seat, and an honest treatment of the fact that most real programmes run more than one delivery approach at once.

Domain 9 · Agile, Scrum and adaptive delivery for project controls — 6 knowledge areas

Agile foundations · The Scrum framework in depth · Backlogs, estimation and agile metrics · Kanban, Lean and scaling · Agile cost control, forecasting and earned value · Hybrid delivery and agile governance

The domain most controls syllabuses skip or wave at. Agile earned value is worked properly: what a baseline means when scope is a backlog, and how to forecast without pretending the plan is fixed.

Domain 10 · Project scheduling, in depth — 4 knowledge areas

Schedule development · Network analysis and the critical path method · Schedule compression and resourcing · Progress measurement and schedule control

The critical path worked in full, forward and backward, by hand. Compression and what it costs. And the progress measurement that decides whether any of it is true.

Domain 11 · Business process cycles — 3 knowledge areas

Order-to-cash · Procure-to-pay · Internal control and segregation of duties

The two cycles your cost data actually travels through, and the control environment deciding whether what arrives in your report can be relied on.

Domain 12 · Risk management for project controls — 3 knowledge areas

The risk framework · The risk process · Contingency and management reserve

Risk as a number belonging in a forecast, not a register nobody reads. Where contingency sits, who may release it, and what the difference between contingency and management reserve means for a figure you publish.

Part Three — AI knowledge and practical approach

Domain 13. Twenty per cent of the Body of Knowledge, under one principle.

Domain 13 · AI for project controls and project management — 7 knowledge areas

AI foundations for professionals · Data: the fuel · Prompting and working with generative AI · AI tool categories for project controls and PM · AI applied across the project-controls lifecycle · Governance, ethics, risk and assurance of AI · Building an AI-augmented project-controls capability

The largest domain in the volume, and the reason the credential exists in this form. It runs from what a model is actually doing, through the data that decides whether it is any use, to where the output stops: a professional who verified it and remains accountable for it.

What sits behind the syllabus

The teaching is held to the **PCI Standards** — 113 mandatory professional standards carrying 532 process requirements. Each states its purpose, who owns the decision, what evidence must exist, what practice is prohibited, what triggers escalation, what AI may assist with and what it must never decide, approve or certify, and a compliance test an assessor can actually perform.

They are certification requirements established by the Institute. They are not legislation, and nothing in the programme is legal, tax or accounting advice.

External frameworks are named where a topic touches them and described in the Institute's own words. No protected text, table, figure or question from any external publication is reproduced, and naming a framework implies nothing about its publisher's view of this programme.

AI proposes; the professional verifies, decides and remains accountable.